

Sony Bravia 7 II

The best LCD TV I've tested this year

₹2,10,890

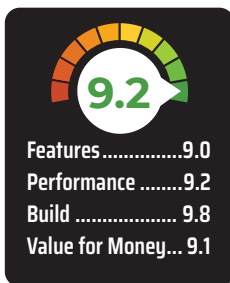


The Sony Bravia 7 II is a new mid-range 4K HDR TV with an advanced RGB LED backlight technology, billed as True RGB. It also brings an XR processor with AI upscaling, XR motion clarity, X-Wide Angle Pro viewing, PS5 optimisations, etc. I reviewed the 55-inch model (K-55XR70M2 IN5).

As a Sony mid-premium flagship TV, we had some expectations for its picture quality and overall offering. Let's see if the Bravia 7 II's new True RGB backlight and Sony's tuning meet that?

DISPLAY PERFORMANCE

The Bravia 7 II uses a 55-inch 4K VA LCD panel with True RGB LED backlight, where each tiny LED cluster consists of independently controlled red, green and blue light. Sony claims this arrangement offers less colour mixing and more authentic colours. In the Calman test, the TV scores 83.01% of BT 2020 gamut coverage (1976 CIE) and 96.56% of DCI-P3 coverage. That's for HDR content, and for SDR, it scored 92.07% in BT709 gamut. These are better



figures than the Bravia 7 with regular Mini LED backlighting.

The Bravia 7 II TV is plenty bright, too. You get to see its full potential in Vivid mode. I watched some FIFA World Cup matches in this mode as the TV lacks a dedicated Sports mode. It was either this or the Standard mode, which offers more muted visuals. Vivid isn't the most authentic in terms of colours, but the bright, saturated presentation can be captivating, even if it comes across as exaggerated to some viewers. It touched 2,110 nits in 10% and 25% windows with max brightness and peak luminance settings.

Black luminance was also excellent at 0.2 nits. So, the TV can present pitch black colour and justify. Content scenes like the night jungle sequence in Raakh Ep 02 and The Revenant; the TV produced uniform, deep blacks without any crushing. To complement this, the strong local dimming ensures there are no obvious haloing or blooming.

For the record, while watching movies, shows and everything except sports, I was using Professional mode.

It offers very natural colours. The brightness is dimmer than Standard or Vivid, as authentic colours are preferred.

Furthermore, you can enable the My Cinema Preset, which adjusts content for the director's cut. Sitting at around 8-10 feet from the TV, with this preset, I played the tense dogfight sequence from Top Gun: Maverick on Prime Video and everything from colour grading, dynamic range, reflections, and motion looked true to the scene. There were no artefacts or visual disturbances in the quick frames of the command room, inside the jet, the facial features of the actors, including sweat, reflections on the jet's glass hood, and the air movement.

I was equally impressed by how the Bravia 7 II presented the Submarine scene from Mission Impossible: Final Reckoning. I was thinking this isn't an OLED, and still, the level of quality is still better than any Mini LED TVs that I recall testing.

Sony doesn't give HDR10+ support. But you get Dolby Vision, IMAX Enhanced and standard HDR10, which should cover a wide library of modern content out there.

For old school shows and movies, Sony offers upscaling, but it is very aggressive, and results in these lower-resolution visuals looking waxy. Another thing you may notice in your everyday use is that the screen is slightly reflective. Even with all the curtains on and no light in the room (except for some monitors that were lit), I could see myself as a ghostly reflection on the screen. Sony's higher-end Bravia 9 II (which is not released in India) boasts an anti-reflective coating, which this one lacks.

Sony has equipped the Bravia 7 II for serious gamers. It supports 4K at 120fps over HDMI 2.1. However, it includes only two HDMI 2.1 ports and two older HDMI 2.0b ports. Both HDMI 2.1 inputs support VRR (Variable Refresh Rate) and ALLM (Auto Low Latency Mode), as well as Dolby Vision gaming. While playing games, you can easily access quick controls and assistance settings via the